

AI ENGINEER CAREER ROADMAP

Personalized 6-Month Transition Plan | Working Professional → AI Engineer

Current: IT Ops / ITSM Professional Goal: AI Engineer Timeline: 6 Months

CURRENT POSITION

You bring strong enterprise IT foundations: **ITSM, ITIL, Microsoft 365, and Intune** — deep experience with structured processes, system administration, ticketing/workflow logic, and enterprise tooling. This is a strategic advantage: most AI Engineers lack real operational/enterprise-systems context. Your gap is technical build skill — Python, ML/LLM fundamentals, and API-driven engineering — not domain understanding.

TARGET GOAL

Become a job-ready **AI Engineer** in 6 months — specifically an **Applied AI / AI Automation Engineer** who builds LLM-powered tools, agents, and integrations (the fastest, most realistic entry point given your enterprise IT background and timeline).

SKILL GAP ANALYSIS

Category	You Have	You Need
Programming	Systems/process logic (ITIL)	Python (core + OOP + APIs)
AI Foundations	None yet	LLM concepts, embeddings, RAG, prompt engineering
Frameworks	M365 / Intune ecosystem	LangChain / LlamaIndex, OpenAI & Claude APIs
Data Handling	ServiceNow data/reporting	SQL, Pandas, vector databases
Deployment	M365/Intune admin/deployment	Git, APIs, cloud (Azure/AWS), basic MLOps
Domain Edge	ITSM + enterprise workflow expertise	Apply it to AI-driven IT automation use cases

RECOMMENDED LEARNING PLAN (6 Months)

Month	Focus	Key Topics
1	Python Foundations	Syntax, data structures, functions, OOP, virtual envs, Git/GitHub basics
2	Data & APIs	Pandas, SQL basics, REST APIs, working with JSON, calling OpenAI/Claude APIs
3	AI/ML Foundations	ML basics, embeddings, vector databases, prompt engineering fundamentals
4	LLM Engineering	LangChain/LlamaIndex, RAG pipelines, function calling, agents
5	Applied Build	Build full AI agent/automation projects; basic cloud deployment (Azure/AWS)
6	Portfolio & Job Prep	Polish 3 projects, resume/LinkedIn rebrand, mock interviews, applications

SUGGESTED PROJECTS

- AI Ticket Triage Bot** — classifies & routes ServiceNow-style tickets using an LLM
- ITSM Knowledge RAG Assistant** — chatbot answering IT policy/ITIL questions from your own docs
- Intune Automation Agent** — AI agent that scripts device compliance checks/reports
- M365 Email/Meeting Summarizer** — LLM tool summarizing inbox or Teams threads via API

NETWORKING STRATEGY

- Post weekly build-in-public updates on LinkedIn (project demos > theory)
- Join AI Engineer & LLM communities (Discord/Slack, r/LocalLLaMA, Latent Space)
- Comment thoughtfully on AI automation/IT-ops crossover content
- Reach out to 2–3 AI Engineers/month for 15-min informational chats
- Position yourself as “the IT Ops person who builds AI automation”

MONTHLY MILESTONES

M1: Comfortable writing Python scripts; GitHub profile live	M4: First working AI agent project deployed
M2: First API-connected script (calls an LLM, processes data)	M5: 2–3 portfolio projects live on GitHub/LinkedIn
M3: Understand RAG/embeddings; small demo built	M6: Rebranded resume/LinkedIn; actively interviewing

IMMEDIATE NEXT ACTIONS (This Week)

- Set up Python + VS Code + GitHub account
- Complete a Python fundamentals crash course (start today)
- Create a “Building in Public: IT Ops → AI Engineer” LinkedIn post
- Get API access (OpenAI or Claude) and run your first “Hello World” API call
- Draft your first project idea: AI Ticket Triage Bot

Generated using Chain-of-Thought Reasoning